

Ecstasy -- Rusted Root

Bass: Harley Benton P/J, 5-string, passive. GP-5 only.

From *When I Woke* (1994). ~102 BPM, est. -- the song's percussion-heavy, tribal-rock groove has a lot of syncopated energy that can feel faster than the underlying tempo suggests.

Rusted Root's whole sound is built on layered hand percussion and a driving, world-fusion groove, with vocals and energy that build toward something genuinely cathartic -- the title says it plainly. The bass needs to lock into that syncopated groove and stay tight through the verses, then help carry the song into its bigger, more intense climactic sections.

CTL off = the grounded, syncopated groove. CTL on = the big, ecstatic climax.

GP-5 settings

Module order: NR -> PRE -> DST -> AMP -> CAB -> EQ -> MOD -> DLY -> RVB.

NR -- Gate

- THRE: 20
- Always on. Moderate threshold -- there's real amp breakup and eventually real drive once the Green OD engages, needs cleanup between the syncopated hits.

PRE -- Micro Boost -- On CTL

- Gain: 52
- CTL off: bypassed (groove). CTL on: engaged (climax).
- Adds extra push on top of the Green OD engagement for the full-intensity climax.

DST -- Green OD (Ibanez TS808) -- On CTL

- Gain: 60, Tone: 55, VOL: 62
- CTL off: bypassed (groove -- amp alone, warm and edge-of-breakup). CTL on: engaged (climax).
- A Tube Screamer-style warm, mid-forward drive rather than a harsher distortion -- fits this song's organic, tribal-rock intensity better than something colder or more aggressive.

AMP/CAB -- NAM SnapTone, slot 54: FullB15 (always on)

- Built from the `Ampeg B18 - Head DI - Bass Chan - Vol 5 (B-18N)` NAM and the Apg115410 IR, combined into one snaptone.
- Real Ampeg B-18N at volume 5, warmer and fuller than the clean capture, into the Apg115410 (1x15 + 4x10) IR.
- Organic, raw, percussion-heavy. The fuller B-15 has warmth and some tube push; the Green OD brings the real grit at the climax.
- Moved off the SoulB18 snaptone (slot 60) 2026-10-02. Michael dropped that combo in the bass VOL audit.
- Gain: 52, VOL: 80, Bass: 56, Middle: 55, Treble: 55
- Gain 52: a little over default. This part wants more push than the other FullB15 patches.
- Bass 56: more low end.
- Middle 55: a touch more midrange.

- Treble 55: a touch more top end.
- VOL 80: the level Michael set for this snaptone in the 2026-10-02 VOL audit. Trim here if the patch jumps in level against your others.
- Same in both CTL states. AMP and CAB are off in the `.prst`, so nothing stacks on the capture. The N->S block calls slot 54 directly.

EQ -- Bass EQ 1

- 33Hz: +3, 150Hz: -1, 600Hz: +2, 2kHz: +4, 8kHz: +2, VOL: 55
- Always on, same for both CTL states.
- +4 at 2kHz is the important one -- this keeps the syncopated groove articulate and readable against a wall of hand percussion, especially once the Green OD kicks in for the climax.

MOD -- Off

- No modulation. This groove needs to stay tight and rhythmically clear -- texture would work against the syncopation, not with it.

DLY -- Off

- Not used, for the same reason.

RVB -- Hall -- On CTL

- Mix: 25, Decay: 38, Trail: On
- CTL off: bypassed (groove -- tight and dry, locked with the percussion). CTL on: engaged (climax).
- Opens the space up for the song's big, cathartic climax -- a genuine "ecstasy" moment deserves some real scale.

CTL summary

- **CTL Off -- Groove.** Tight, syncopated, warm edge-of-breakup tone locked in with the percussion.
- **CTL On -- Climax.** Green OD and Micro Boost engage, Hall opens up -- bigger, more intense, matching the song's cathartic build.
- Engage CTL as the song builds into its most intense sections, back off returning to the grounded groove.

Note on GP-5-only

This patch is GP-5 only -- no pedalboard beyond the Valeton GP-5 itself. All the tone (groove, drive, space) comes from the GP-5's own modules above.